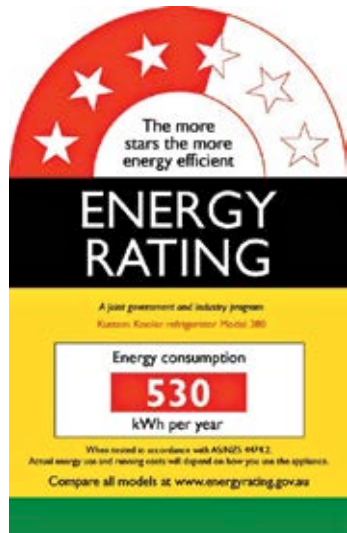


efficient appliances is analogous to buying a car or a house with a marginally higher down payment but lower EMIs. You're actually SAVING money in the long run.

Holding on to old appliances is a form of recycling

While you might be tempted to hang on to that old washing machine or electric geyser that you bought with your first pay cheque, you'll be disappointed to know that it doesn't constitute recycling. Home appliances, particularly washing machines, dishwashers, heating /cooling appliances and incandescent bulbs actually get more energy inefficient with age, so it's probably a good idea to buy newer ones. Most new appliances are engineered with the intention of cutting down on wasteful energy expenditure and come with an energy 'star' rating - the more stars a product has, the more money and energy you'll save every year in using that product.

Another little known practice that can effectively reduce the stress on our power grids is choosing the time of the day to perform your daily (energy consuming) chores. The energy demand from power stations during the peak hours of the day (9am to 6pm) tends to be much higher, and coping with additional power requirements during these hours can prove disastrous to the environment in the form of increased utilization of coal. Try to schedule your tasks either before or after this period, or put them off until the weekend.



Look for the star rating while buying a new appliance

Organic foods are healthier and more environment friendly

Organic foods, when they arrived, seemed like a win-win situation for the farmers, consumers and the environment as well. They cost more